

Boostlingo – Best practices quick guide

Accuracy:

- Always listen carefully to both parties, and take notes.
- If one of the parties is providing you with too much information, identify as the interpreter, and request them to speak in shorter sentences.
- Always interpret everything that is said during the call.
- **Avoid omitting, changing, or adding anything to the message. Keep it faithful to the original one.**
- Make sure to maintain the register and style of the message.

Professionalism and protocols:

Clarification and Repetition

- If you are in doubt regarding anything that has been said, please, feel free to request a clarification or repetition to ensure accuracy.
- If you notice that the provider and LEP can communicate without your services, identify as the interpreter, and ask them if your services are still needed.

Interventions

- When intervening to request clarification/repetition, always identify yourself as the interpreter.

CLARIFICATION AND REPETITIONS
<i>Interpreters occasionally must interrupt a session to problem solve a barrier to communication. To maintain transparency the interpreter informs all parties what is said, including what the interpreter says when they intervene to solve a problem.</i>
Clarification/Repetition:
• Excuse the interpreter, may I ask you for a repetition?
• Excuse the interpreter may I ask your client/patient for a repetition?
• Excuse me, as the interpreter, can you please repeat XXX term?
• Excuse me, as the interpreter, I just asked for a repetition of XXX term.
• Excuse me, as the interpreter I need to ask your client/patient to clarify XXX.
• Excuse me, as the interpreter, I need you to clarify XXX.
For any issues, LEP uses profanity, do NOT get involved but explain situation to the client:

<i>"Excuse the interpreter (Provide description of the situation), how would you like me to proceed?"</i>
To resolve a platform or technological problem:
• Excuse me, as the interpreter, I cannot hear you. Can you check your sound/adjust the position of your device/etc.? • Excuse me, as the interpreter, I just requested that the speaker check their sound/adjust the position of their device/etc.
To address a cultural barrier to communication (for community/medical only:
• Excuse me, as the interpreter, I think there may be a break in communication due to a cultural reason. • Excuse me, as the interpreter, I just suggested that there may be a break in communication due to a cultural reason.
For Shorter sentences:
<i>"Excuse the interpreter, may I ask your client to speak in short sentences, this will guarantee the accuracy of the interpretation"</i>
REMEMBER - First Person Interpretation:
Professional interpreters interpret in "first person," that is, they use direct speech. For example, if the Doctor says, "I am glad to see you today" , the interpreter says, "I am glad to see you today," and not "the doctor says she is glad to see you today" .
• <i>There are appropriate exceptions to this practice when an interpreter can switch to third person:</i>
<i>o The use of first person is causing confusion for the limited English speaker e.g., a confused mental health patient or a child.</i>
<i>o During emergency situations.</i>

Transparency with both parties when doing clarification

- Avoid using filler words, try not to hesitate during the renditions, and always make sure to provide the hold time policy when needed.
- Make sure all the parties are kept on the loop of what is being said during the call.
- Be ready to interpret, but avoid speaking over the other parties.

Other best practices:

- When taking calls, make sure your surroundings are HIPAA complaint (No background noise).
- Check if you do not have your microphone too close to your mouth.

- Always be polite, and respectful to all parties. Avoid raising your voice, and try to maintain the same tone of voice as the other parties.
- Maintain a good connection at all times. Always take a speedtest before your shift, and in case you have any issues during your shift, you can always take another one.
- Use the correct opening, pre-session and closing for all calls.

Opening for OPI and VRI calls:	
CTS IVR calling: (you will press 1 to accept)	Agent calling: say HELLO - wait for agent to give instructions.
Opening to English Speaker:	
"Hello my name is XXXX , my ID is NUMBER and I am your LANGUAGE interpreter. How may I help you?"	
OPTIONAL, For OPI/VRI sessions, if time allows, the interpreter may add any or all of the following:	
"I will interpret everything that is said", "I will maintain confidentiality", "Please speak to each other directly", "I will interrupt if I need you to pause so I can interpret"	
IMPORTANT	
If you notice a Client Intake , make sure to ask the each question on the intake after you have disclosed the Opening Statement to client.	
Keep in mind all questions on the intake are meant to be asked to the English Speaker	
Do NOT fill the intake with your own information	
Intakes are to be filled out with either the English Speaker or LEP's information.	
Opening to LEP:	
Hello I will be your interpreter today... (Continue with client's instructions)	
Once you are done with the call, remember to provide CLOSING STATEMENT (OPI & VRI calls):	
"Is there anything else I can assist you with?"	
"Thank you, LANGUAGE interpreter #12345 is disconnecting"	